including repairs, refits, and upgrades. This dependence is reducing, but Russia remains India's principal supplier of weapons systems and equipment. According to the Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI), 56 percent of India's arms imports in the period 2015–19 was from Russia, followed by Israel (14 percent) and France (12 percent) as India's second and third largest suppliers, respectively.[19]

China's assertive behaviour in its neighbourhood and its expanding economic and naval presence in the Indo-Pacific, particularly the Indian Ocean, have inspired India's ambitious plans to expand its naval presence in the region. Russia plays an important role in this – with supplies of an aircraft carrier, submarines and frigates, leasing of a nuclear-powered submarine, and technology support for indigenous development of naval platforms. As India strives to build an indigenous weapons manufacturing industry, Russia has been more forthcoming than other suppliers in transferring advanced military technologies. Discussions for transfer of cutting-edge US or European defence technologies have not progressed satisfactorily, because many of these technologies are privately owned and companies are not willing to undermine their competitiveness by parting with them. The recent US decision to extend to India the same treatment as its allies in the matter of transfer of advanced military technologies may contribute to improving this picture.

In addition to defence cooperation, geography is an important factor in India–Russia relations. Russia is a huge landmass to India's north, bordering much of its near and extended neighbourhood, where India has political, economic, energy, consular, and security interests. Its actions in Afghanistan, Syria, Iran, and the rest of West Asia impact India in various ways. China has an increasing